

ATTRACTION: Archaeological Museum

ALTERNATIVE NAMES:

Nalanda Museum

LOCATION:

Nalanda, Bihar

DISTRICT / REGION:

Nalanda

CATEGORY:

Museum

OVERVIEW:

Nalanda Museum is one of the most prestigious site-museums of the Archaeological Survey of India. It houses antiquities found at the site of the ancient Nalanda Mahavihara, the earliest university cum monastery complex.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

The museum displays about 350 ancient artifacts across four galleries and a main hall, while more than thirteen thousand artifacts are securely kept in the reserve collection. The rich display includes stone images and sculptures, bronzes, stuccos, terracottas, inscriptions, iron objects, ivory and bone objects, and potteries, offering an exceptional glimpse into the art and life of the Nalanda Mahavihara. The Mahavihara flourished between the 5th and 12th centuries under the patronage of the Gupta, Maukhari, and Pala rulers.

HISTORICAL OR CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE:

It preserves the heritage of Nalanda Mahavihara, which flourished during the 5th – 12th centuries CE under prominent dynasties. The collection embodies the high point of Buddhist art and ancient Indian education.

LEGENDS, STORIES, OR TRADITIONS:

Not Mentioned

KEY HIGHLIGHTS:

- Showcases 350 artifacts found at Nalanda Mahavihara, with over 13,000 in reserve.
- Artifacts date from the 5th to the 12th century CE.
- Collections feature stone images, bronzes, stuccos, terracottas, and inscriptions.
- Four galleries and a main hall.

VISITOR INFORMATION:

Best Time To Visit:

October to March

Opening Hours:

09:00AM - 05:00PM (Friday closed)

Entry Fee:

Rs. 05

Duration Recommended:

Not Mentioned

Photography:

Videography & Photography Allowed

Accessibility Information:

Not Mentioned

FACILITIES:

Parking, Restaurant, Drinking Water, Videography & Photography Allowed, Souvenir Shop

TRANSPORTATION:

Nearest Airport:

Patna

Distance From Airport:

86 Kms

Nearest Railway Station:

Nalanda

Distance From Railway Station:

03 Kms

Nearest Bus Stand:

Nalanda

Distance From Bus Stand:

02 Kms

Road Connectivity:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Tourist Information Centre:

Tourist Information Centre, Nalanda

Nearest Police Station:

Nalanda (03 Kms), Ph : 06112-281827

Nearest Medical Facility:

Sadar Hospital, Biharsharif, Ph : 06112-236779

NEARBY ATTRACTIONS:

- Old University (02 Kms)
- Black Buddha (02 Kms)
- Hien Tsang Memorial Hall (02 Kms)
- Sun Temple Pond (02 Kms)

FESTIVALS AND EVENTS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL CULTURE AND EXPERIENCES:

Offers a profound educational experience diving deep into the artifacts left by monks, scholars, and rulers of ancient India.

LOCAL FOOD AND CUISINE:

Not Mentioned

SHOPPING AND SOUVENIRS:

Souvenir Shop is available.

ACCOMMODATION:

- Restaurant, Nalanda

HOTELS:

- Restaurant, Nalanda, Mob : 9973619507

LOCAL GUIDES:

- Santosh Kumar, Mob : 9801399926
- Shiv Priye, Mob : 9334943534
- Navin Kumar, Mob : 7903580307
- Sanjay Kumar, Mob : 9608646853

TRAVEL OPERATORS:

- Sanjay Kr. Pandey , Mob : 9308051657
- Praveen Kumar, Mob : 7301502535
- Sanjay Kumar, Mob : 8434153559
- Praveen Kumar, Mob : 9155764270
- Pradeep Kumar, Mob : 9934051597
- Aditya Kumar, Mob : 9931271352
- Pravin Kumar , Mob : 9955393911

IMPORTANT FACTS:

- Museum houses antiquities patronized by Gupta, Maukhari, and Pala rulers.
- More than 13,000 artifacts are kept in reserve.

RETRIEVAL SUMMARY:

The Archaeological Museum in Nalanda is a prestigious ASI site-museum housing antiquities from the Nalanda Mahavihara. It displays 350 artifacts (with over 13,000 in reserve), including stone sculptures, bronzes, and terracottas from the 5th-12th centuries CE under the Gupta, Maukhari, and Pala rulers. Open from October to March (09:00AM - 05:00PM, closed Fridays) with an entry fee of Rs. 05. It features parking, a restaurant, and a souvenir shop.

QUESTION-ANSWER FACTS:

Q: What is this attraction known for?

A: It is known for housing and displaying ancient antiquities found at the ruins of Nalanda Mahavihara.

Q: Where is it located?

A: Nalanda, Bihar.

Q: What are the nearby attractions?

A: Old University, Black Buddha, Hien Tsang Memorial Hall, and Sun Temple Pond.

Q: How can visitors reach it?

A: Nearest airport is Patna (86 Kms), nearest railway station is Nalanda (03 Kms), and nearest bus stand is Nalanda (02 Kms).

Q: What is the entry fee?

A: Rs. 05.

KEYWORDS:

Archaeological Museum Nalanda, Nalanda Museum, ASI site-museum Bihar, Nalanda Mahavihara antiquities, Gupta Pala artifacts, ancient stone images Nalanda.